To the New World

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COL-800301

The druid is taking a stroll through the war-torn woods.

She rests her hand on the scarred trunk of an olive tree, intently listening to its quiet whispers in the wind.

Druvis III: A beautiful morning to you, Vertin.

Druvis III: As you described, this is a forest worth looking forward to.

Druvis III: The branches of the trees are arranged in a perfect pattern, showing a sense of harmony and unity. I can see the gentle and caring nature of the guardian of the forest.

Vertin: That is a high praise.

Druvis III: Indeed. All branches follow the same pattern and grow in the same way.

Druvis III: The edges of squares give rise to triangles, and the edges of triangles give rise to squares.

Druvis III: I may not be familiar with this trimming style, but I can hear the trees humming with joy.

Vertin: That pattern is called the Pythagoras tree.

Druvis III: I have heard of this Pythagoras. He was a mathematician.

Druvis III: Little did I know that his theorem could be expressed on trees.

Druvis III: My respects to the sagacity of the ancients.

Choices

1. How have you been keeping?
2. Arcana has finally been defeated
3. I should get going

Branch 1

Druvis III: I'm grateful for your concern, Vertin.

Druvis III: I am well. The Foundation did not make it hard for me to repair the square.

Druvis III: Instead, they collected data on the potential damage that the proliferating plants could cause to the Foundation's infrastructure.

Druvis III: They also thoroughly examined the growth potions made by Ms. Sotheby.

Druvis III: So it seems our next protest will need a new strategy, it won't be as easy.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 2

Druvis III: Defeating Arcana ... I am not certain she can be defeated.

Druvis III: To defeat an entity like her, one must first understand her intentions.

Druvis III: Manus Vindictae's purpose is clear, but Arcana's is a mystery.

Druvis III: She didn't care about anything, based on the time I spent with her.

Druvis III: In accordance with the laws of nature, fruits fall, seeds take root, and trees bear new produce.

Druvis III: The tree can be pruned, its fruit thinned, and even cut down to change its appearance.

Druvis III: Yet, the inherent law of nature cannot be altered.

Druvis III: To me, Arcana is like an unchangeable law, one without any purpose. It cannot be overcome, just as it cannot be changed.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Druvis III: I would love to talk to the trees again, they are delightful. Farewell for now.

[English text unavailable]

COL-800302

Druvis III: We meet again, Vertin. Are you here to talk to the trees too?

Choices

1. How have you been keeping?
2. Arcana has finally been defeated
3. I should get going

Branch 1

Druvis III: I'm grateful for your concern, Vertin.

Druvis III: I am well. The Foundation did not make it hard for me to repair the square.

Druvis III: Instead, they collected data on the potential damage that the proliferating plants could cause to the Foundation's infrastructure.

Druvis III: They also thoroughly examined the growth potions made by Ms. Sotheby.

Druvis III: So it seems our next protest will need a new strategy, it won't be as easy.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 2

Druvis III: Defeating Arcana ... I am not certain she can be defeated.

Druvis III: To defeat an entity like her, one must first understand her intentions.

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Druvis III: To me, Arcana is like an unchangeable law, one without any purpose. It cannot be overcome, just as it cannot be changed.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Druvis III: I would love to talk to the trees again, they are delightful. Farewell for now.

[English text unavailable]

COL-800401

That 768-nautical-mile flight was barely a warmup for the pilot and her trusty broom.

Perched at the highest point on the island, she takes a moment to fully savor her most recent flight.

She takes a deep swig from her canteen before shaking her head.

Lilya: Hey, Vertin! Come, drink with me.

Lilya: Only kids like Regulus drink soda. You should get used to Vodka.

Vertin: I'm underage too.

Lilya: Sheesh. You were never the model student, but now you sound like one.

Lilya: If you're not into drinking holy water, at least chat with me.

Lilya: Or the joy of drinking will be lost.

Choices

1. Why did you decide to become a pilot?
2. Have you heard anything from Zeno?
3. I should get going

Branch 1

Lilya: Now that's a topic to get the sips flowing! Who isn't up for a little reminiscing while drinking?

Lilya: I became a pilot because I love flying, obviously!

Lilya: Ah, the wind rushing past you, the thrill of acceleration ...

Lilya: ... the weightlessness and adrenaline while chasing the enemy.

Lilya: The best part is the screaming when you slice apart their plane.

Lilya: Call me disloyal if you want, but to me, Zeno was just a place to get a pilot's license.

Lilya: Ever since I got my papers and an aircraft, I had been looking for a place to fly freely.

Lilya: In Zeno, I needed a mission to fly. At the Foundation, my role would've been reduced to a mere instructor. So I looked for a place with endless problems where I could have unlimited fun in the air.

Lilya: Can you guess where I ended up?

Lilya: Your suitcase.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 2

Lilya: Zeno? It's a party over there.

Lilya: They've been wanting to erase Arcana from existence since 1999.

Lilya: And they finally did. The bomb flattened the entire military base, leaving nothing behind. The authorities have officially confirmed her death.

Lilya: Now everyone in Zeno is celebrating the victory.

Lilya: There was a commendation ceremony. Even the dogs were honored with medals.

Lilya: But accolades mean nothing to me, so here I am, talking to you.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Lilya: Bye. Maybe you can join me for another ride some time.

Lilya: Not like the last time when you were sick, but in an actual air fight!

[English text unavailable]

COL-800402

Lilya: Ready to catch the wind? Or did you forget something here?

Choices

1. Why did you decide to become a pilot?

2. Have you heard anything from Zeno?

3. I should get going

Branch 1

Lilya: Now that's a topic to get the sips flowing! Who isn't up for a little reminiscing while drinking?

Lilya: I became a pilot because I love flying, obviously!

Lilya: Ah, the wind rushing past you, the thrill of acceleration ...

Lilya: ... the weightlessness and adrenaline while chasing the enemy.

Lilya: The best part is the screaming when you slice apart their plane.

Lilya: Call me disloyal if you want, but to me, Zeno was just a place to get a pilot's license.

Lilya: Ever since I got my papers and an aircraft, I had been looking for a place to fly freely.

Lilya: In Zeno, I needed a mission to fly. At the Foundation, my role would've been reduced to a mere instructor. So I looked for a place with endless problems where I could have unlimited fun in the air.

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1. I should get going

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Lilya: There was a commendation ceremony. Even the dogs were honored with medals.

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Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Lilya: Bye. Maybe you can join me for another ride some time.

Lilya: Not like the last time when you were sick, but in an actual air fight!

[English text unavailable]

COL-800501

The long journey wears you down. It's only your force of will that has carried you this far.

But the rockin' pirate is still filled to the brim with energy.

She finds a smooth, flat rock that still holds some warmth from the sun, taking a seat before raising her drink in a toast toward the horizon. The last can of Dr. Papper rests beside her.

Regulus: Ahh! That's the stuff! Nothing beats a Dr. Papper after saving the day!

Regulus: What? Are you worrying about other things? We just took down Arcana and snagged the "Storm" immunity. Why not kick back for a minute, mate?

Regulus: The best bit about this whole thing is, I ended up with two ships in one day!

Regulus: Let's treat ourselves to fizzy drinks and get all puffed up today!

Choices

1. Take the last can of Dr. Papper

2. I thought you'd prefer celebrating with coffee

Branch 1

Why wouldn't you celebrate? There's no earthly reason to decline such a kind offer.

Regulus: To Vertin!

Branch 2

Regulus: Ha! The brown bean juice the math geeks hate so much? You think I'd make a fuss again?

Regulus: Well, coffee would be lovely, but right now Dr. Papper is my jam. So eh, maybe next time.

Shared continuation

It's a fine respite—as she said, there is nothing stopping you from enjoying the refreshing flavor of the bubbling soft drinks.

Choices

1. What does the great rockin' pirate think of this voyage?

2. Do you think we'll ever make it back to our own time?

3. I have to go Thanks for the Dr. Papper

Branch 1

Regulus: Aside from my sinking ship? Not too shabby. Plenty of adventures, surprises, and treasures. The only problem? This bloody island.

Regulus: So many rules! Can't even eat beans without getting a lecture. What's with the Abraxases biting people? What's with people biting people?!

Regulus: Don't they understand that rules are made to be broken?

Regulus: No way people this obstinate could ever write good lyrics. Can you imagine 6 spitting rhymes? I'm dead!

Regulus: But let's be honest, that last meal was absolutely smashing. They went out with a bang, didn't they?

Regulus: Striding into the "Storm" to prove their beliefs ... How cool was that?

Regulus: I was half tempted to join them! But I reined it in, not today. This rockin' pirate will never suffer the same fate of those number-crunchers,

Regulus: because my grand finale will be the one that rocks the world, mate!

Choices

1. I have to go； Thanks for the Dr. Papper

Branch 2

Regulus: Of course. We already have the Equilibrium Umbrella saving us from the "Storm."

Regulus: Just got to put it into production and distribute it worldwide, give it a hundred years,

Regulus: and bam—it'll be the year 2000 in no time!

Regulus: Alright, maybe that's a biiit too long, but we can find a better way for sure!

Regulus: And there's no solid proof that the "Storm" only takes us back to the 20th century, is there?

Regulus: What if, as the dorky biter would say, there is such a thing as a white crow?

Regulus: Maybe the next "Storm" will take us to the future! A future where we can sail into space! I'm gonna be a rockin' space pirate, that's for sure!

Regulus: And we'll pop over to Leo and see if any aliens are up for some rock and roll!

Choices

1. I have to go； Thanks for the Dr. Papper

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Regulus: Glad you enjoyed that. If you ever want more Dr. Papper, I'm here for you.

[English text unavailable]

COL-800502

Regulus: What? Back for more Dr. Papper?

Choices

1. Take the last can of Dr Papper

2. I thought you'd prefer celebrating with coffee

Branch 1

Why wouldn't you celebrate? There's no earthly reason to decline such a kind offer.

Regulus: To Vertin!

Branch 2

Regulus: Ha! The brown bean juice the math geeks hate so much? You think I'd make a fuss again?

Regulus: Well, coffee would be lovely, but right now Dr. Papper is my jam. So eh, maybe next time.

Shared continuation

Choices

1. What does the great rockin' pirate think of this voyage?

2. Do you think we'll ever make it back to our own time?

3. I have to go Thanks for the Dr Papper

Branch 1

Regulus: Aside from my sinking ship? Not too shabby. Plenty of adventures, surprises, and treasures. The only problem? This bloody island.

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Regulus: Don't they understand that rules are made to be broken?

Regulus: No way people this obstinate could ever write good lyrics. Can you imagine 6 spitting rhymes? I'm dead!

Regulus: But let's be honest, that last meal was absolutely smashing. They went out with a bang, didn't they?

Regulus: Striding into the "Storm" to prove their beliefs ... How cool was that?

Regulus: I was half tempted to join them! But I reined it in, not today. This rockin' pirate will never suffer the same fate of those number-crunchers,

Regulus: because my grand finale will be the one that rocks the world, mate!

Choices

1. I have to go Thanks for the Dr Papper

Branch 2

Regulus: Of course. We already have the Equilibrium Umbrella saving us from the "Storm."

Regulus: Just got to put it into production and distribute it worldwide, give it a hundred years,

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Regulus: And we'll pop over to Leo and see if any aliens are up for some rock and roll!

Choices

1. I have to go Thanks for the Dr Papper

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Regulus: Glad you enjoyed that. If you ever want more Dr. Papper, I'm here for you.

[English text unavailable]

COL-800901

The little lady is trudging along the beach, dragging a suitcase stuffed to the brim behind her.

She rarely travels with much luggage, usually preferring to tuck everything into her dress.

You can't help but wonder what she could have brought along that would be worth all this trouble.

Sotheby: Um ... Is there a gentleman who can help me?

Sotheby: Oh, it's Vertin! Hooray! Could you act the part of a gentleman and help me carry this suitcase?

Vertin: What's in it?

Sotheby: The moving pictures of Typhon I chose for my new island friends, including Typhon and the Auto Island ...

Sotheby: Typhon and the Pegasus, Typhon and the Battle Against Jupiter ... All are perfect gifts for new friends!

Sotheby: I know what you're worrying about, but ... don't worry!

Sotheby: Ms. Moissan approved my request, so I asked the Foundation to make copies for everyone!

Sotheby: Even though she said something like "No Copyright issues in this time and year ..."

Sotheby: Is copying not right in this era? Typhon never cared about such details when sharing with friends!

You notice strips of black plastic peeking out from her suitcase—they appear to be films.

Sotheby: Could you carry the suitcase for me? Bless your heart!

Vertin: Of course. Leave it to me.

It's better not to expose the films to open light. You take the case in your only free hand.

Sotheby: Thanks again, Vertin! Say, do you happen to know of any dark and empty rooms?

Sotheby: We can enjoy Typhon's moving pictures on a wall there with our new friends!

Choices

1. How have things been at the Foundation?
2. So, there's been another "Storm"
3. You can leave Typhon to me

Branch 1

Sotheby: Thank you for asking, Vertin!

Sotheby: Everyone at the Foundation may look tough, but they're all really friendly.

Sotheby: You see, they only asked for 500,000 Sharpodonties as the compensation for turning the Foundation building into a tree house.

Sotheby: 500,000! Can you believe it? That's not even worth a dragon's heart! I have a feeling the so-called compensation was just a gesture to alleviate my guilt. They were too considerate to embarrass a lady.

Sotheby: How chivalrous they were!

Sotheby: Besides, I also got acquainted with the great Ms. Bouanich! She is a lovely lady who has been guiding me through the Foundation.

Sotheby: I would have loved to hold a ball to show my appreciation, but Mr. Karson told me that if a lady always responds with "I need to think about it," then her answer is no.

Sotheby: Perhaps she is not into balls? Have you known Ms. Bouanich for long, Vertin? Could you possibly share her interests with me?

Choices

1. You can leave Typhon to me

Branch 2

Sotheby: Yes! Another "Storm" we braved together!

Sotheby: Even though there was a tense atmosphere before the "Storm," everyone was on edge.

Sotheby: Their discussions were too hard to understand, I couldn't keep up!

Sotheby: But good thing I was the best potion alchemist around!

Sotheby: I whipped up helpful potions without even knowing what they were saying!

Sotheby: I'll tell you a secret formula, Vertin.

Sotheby: Add three grams of gold powder to coffee and it becomes a refreshing potion!

Sotheby: It works the best when you add it in front of their faces.

Sotheby: Coffee and gold are an addictive combination, so don't get carried away.

Sotheby: Remember, don't drink more than three grams of gold a day, and politely say no to anyone who asks for a lot of gold!

Choices

1. You can leave Typhon to me

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Sotheby: I knew it, Vertin. You must really enjoy lugging suitcases around.

[English text unavailable]

COL-800902

Sotheby: Greetings, Vertin. How may I be of assistance to you?

Choices

1. How have things been at the Foundation?

2. So, there's been another 'Storm'

3. You can leave the case to me I'll look for a room where we can play them

Branch 1

Sotheby: Thank you for asking, Vertin!

Sotheby: Everyone at the Foundation may look tough, but they're all really friendly.

Sotheby: You see, they only asked for 500,000 Sharpodonties as the compensation for turning the Foundation building into a tree house.

Sotheby: 500,000! Can you believe it? That's not even worth a dragon's heart! I have a feeling the so-called compensation was just a gesture to alleviate my guilt. They were too considerate to embarrass a lady.

Sotheby: How chivalrous they were!

Sotheby: Besides, I also got acquainted with the great Ms. Bouanich! She is a lovely lady who has been guiding me through the Foundation.

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Choices

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Branch 2

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Sotheby: It works the best when you add it in front of their faces.

Sotheby: Coffee and gold are an addictive combination, so don't get carried away.

Sotheby: Remember, don't drink more than three grams of gold a day, and politely say no to anyone who asks for a lot of gold!

Choices

1. You can leave the case to me I'll look for a room where we can play them

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Sotheby: I knew it, Vertin. You must really enjoy lugging suitcases around.

[English text unavailable]

COL-801001

Laplace's unpredictable inventor is busy building another mysterious device on the island.

It appears to resemble a catapult.

X: Hey, Vertin, what a lucky surprise.

X: I'm setting up a new Goldberg machine, this place is going to be a hub.

X: When a seagull glides over the ocean and builds a nest on one end of this lever, a stone will be flung from the other end.

X: Which will fly all the way to ...

X: Hm. Though the fun will be spoiled if I tell you now. See for yourself when I'm done.

X: Why don't we talk about something else, like Laplace? You might wanna hear what a mess it is over there.

Choices

1. Has Laplace decided who will be Lucy's successor?

2. I heard an Awakened employee started a hunger strike

3. I'd better get going

Branch 1

X: They have no idea who can take her place. She was much loved, as one could tell from that epic farewell.

X: Nobody has the courage to sit on her recharger throne, as you never know when you'll get burned.

X: And it will take some time to transform the office back into a space for living beings to use.

X: I have to admit that sometimes I prefer the chaos. Since nobody has time to tell us what to do, we already have exciting projects in the pipeline.

Choices

1. I'd better get going

Branch 2

X: You mean Ulrich. He's still on hunger strike, camping out in front of the committee building day in and day out.

X: He was alone at first, then some human researchers and arcanists joined him.

X: Even though none of them could last as long as Ulrich.

X: Eventually the Foundation employees arrived, pushing a cart full of food. Ulrich's scream of "traitors!" was so loud that it was hard to believe he could make such a sound.

X: But he also has a lot of work to do, so I assume he'll be there a few days and will have to end the strike as deadlines approach.

Choices

1. I'd better get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

X: I'll catch you later, I've got a couple of gadgets to tune up.

[English text unavailable]

COL-801002

X: Hey again! What's our topic for this round?

Choices

1. Has Laplace decided who will be Lucy's successor?

2. I heard an Awakened employee started a hunger strike

3. I'd better get going

Branch 1

X: They have no idea who can take her place. She was much loved, as one could tell from that epic farewell.

X: Nobody has the courage to sit on her recharger throne, as you never know when you'll get burned.

X: And it will take some time to transform the office back into a space for living beings to use.

X: I have to admit that sometimes I prefer the chaos. Since nobody has time to tell us what to do, we already have exciting projects in the pipeline.

Choices

1. I'd better get going

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X: But he also has a lot of work to do, so I assume he'll be there a few days and will have to end the strike as deadlines approach.

Choices

1. I'd better get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

X: I'll catch you later, I've got a couple of gadgets to tune up.

[English text unavailable]

COL-802301

You know your chief assistant will be here, just like she knows you'll come looking for her.

It's been ages since you last saw her in anything other than the Foundation uniform.

That's how you know an actual holiday is finally here.

Sonetto: Good morning, Timekeeper, we have finally completed all of our assigned tasks.

Sonetto: The Foundation gave me a break, but ...

Sonetto: I don't know what to do with my free time ... Would you mind if I spent some time with you?

Vertin: Certainly, we can chat a little.

Her tense shoulders fall with relief.

Sonetto: Thank you, Timekeeper! I wanted to talk to you about the mission we just had, especially about Sophia ...

Sonetto: Sorry, this is about to sound like a work report ...

Sonetto: I'm not very good at small talk. Can you start the conversation?

Choices

1. We'll meet Sophia again

2. What's your plan moving forward?

3. Sorry, I have other things to tend to

Branch 1

Sonetto: Yes, as enemies.

Sonetto: I could not understand her motives. She was one of the most devout believers I knew, so why did she turn her back on Apeiron?

Sonetto: She knew Manus Vindictae never cared for the lives of others. She witnessed the suicide attacks carried out by Manus followers on the island. She experienced it all firsthand.

Sonetto: I know that their intention was to provoke war, and the invading soldiers must've had their assistance.

Sonetto: The islanders were thrust into war, their beliefs shattered, and their vulnerability then exploited by the Manus, who welcomed them with open arms.

Sonetto: I feel frustrated, like I've lost another debate. I knew the right answers, but could not articulate it. I had to watch them die without being able to convince them otherwise.

Sonetto: ... I wish I didn't lose this debate, Timekeeper.

Choices

1. Sorry, I have other things to tend to

Branch 2

Sonetto: I will do everything in my power to prevent tragedies like Sophia's and Schneider's from happening again.

Sonetto: No matter how impossible it may seem right now, I will find a way.

Sonetto: Sorry, those were big words, I know.

Sonetto: What I really want to do is ...

Sonetto: To keep being your assistant, Timekeeper.

Sonetto: For it is my duty and my own will.

Sonetto: Let us do this together, Timekeeper.

Choices

1. Sorry, I have other things to tend to

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Sonetto: It's okay, Timekeeper. Don't let me keep you. I'm not going anywhere.

Sonetto: We can talk later, when you have time.

[English text unavailable]

COL-802302

Sonetto: I'm here, Timekeeper. Are you free now?

Choices

1. We'll meet Sophia again
2. What's your plan moving forward?
3. Sorry, I have other things to tend to

Branch 1

Sonetto: Yes, as enemies.

Sonetto: I could not understand her motives. She was one of the most devout believers I knew, so why did she turn her back on Apeiron?

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Choices

1. Sorry, I have other things to tend to

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Sonetto: It's okay, Timekeeper. Don't let me keep you. I'm not going anywhere.

Sonetto: We can talk later, when you have time.

[English text unavailable]

COL-802701

The green radio is basking under the sun, bathing in its warmth.

Since she doesn't have a human face to make expressions, it's hard to read her mood.

However, since the 5th Dimension's "Aquarius" is playing from her speakers, it might suggest she is in good spirits.

She snaps up the moment she notices your presence, and the music shifts to a four-note motif—just like Beethoven's fate knocking at the door.

Ms. Radio: He-hello? Ms. Vertin, what brings you here? Have they finally decided my verdict?

Ms. Radio: I hope my recent actions were enough to prove my innocence ...

She shivers nervously, and the music seems to crackle along with her.

Choices

1. Of course In fact,
we couldn't have achieved any of this without you

2. Could you find a person for me?

3. I shall leave you to your leisure

Branch 1

Ms. Radio: Really? That is wonderful news! I am relieved to hear that I have been helpful.

Ms. Radio: These past few days have left me on edge, wondering if they would pry open my battery cover, or submerge me in Formalin ...

Ms. Radio: ... or even take me apart in search of enemy signals ...

Ms. Radio: Thank you for your confidence in me, Ms. Vertin.

Ms. Radio: So, am I allowed to move freely within the Foundation now?

Ms. Radio: I could use a little cleaning, polishing, and perhaps a coat of wax, if I can find someone to do it.

Choices

1. I shall leave you to your leisure

Branch 2

Ms. Radio: Certainly. Which DJ do you have in mind? Or are we looking for updates on a particular politician?

Ms. Radio: From AM to FM, I'll scan through all the frequencies, just for you.

Vertin: The name is Urd.

Ms. Radio: Ah, the biographer. She is the reason we embarked on this great journey. What intrigues you about her?

Vertin: ... I can't be sure. It's just a gut feeling.

Ms. Radio: Oh ... I didn't mean to pry.

Ms. Radio: I will gladly help and pay close attention to the name. If it comes up in the news, I'll let you know right away.

Choices

1. I shall leave you to your leisure

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Ms. Radio: In that case, why don't we enjoy a little pampering time together?

Ms. Radio: We could slather ourselves in machine oil, bask in the sun, and let the rays zap our impurities away.

[English text unavailable]

COL-802702

Ms. Radio: Did you find something, Ms. Vertin?

Choices

1. Of course In fact,
we couldn't have achieved any of this without you

2. Could you find a person for me?

3. I shall leave you to your leisure

Branch 1

Ms. Radio: Really? That is wonderful news! I am relieved to hear that I have been helpful.

Ms. Radio: These past few days have left me on edge, wondering if they would pry open my battery cover, or submerge me in Formalin ...

Ms. Radio: ... or even take me apart in search of enemy signals ...

Ms. Radio: Thank you for your confidence in me, Ms. Vertin.

Ms. Radio: So, am I allowed to move freely within the Foundation now?

Ms. Radio: I could use a little cleaning, polishing, and perhaps a coat of wax, if I can find someone to do it.

Choices

1. I shall leave you to your leisure

Branch 2

Ms. Radio: Certainly. Which DJ do you have in mind? Or are we looking for updates on a particular politician?

Ms. Radio: From AM to FM, I'll scan through all the frequencies, just for you.

Vertin: The name is Urd.

Ms. Radio: Ah, the biographer. She is the reason we embarked on this great journey. What intrigues you about her?

Vertin: ... I can't be sure. It's just a gut feeling.

Ms. Radio: Oh ... I didn't mean to pry.

Ms. Radio: I will gladly help and pay close attention to the name. If it comes up in the news, I'll let you know right away.

Choices

1. I shall leave you to your leisure

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Ms. Radio: In that case, why don't we enjoy a little pampering time together?

Ms. Radio: We could slather ourselves in machine oil, bask in the sun, and let the rays zap our impurities away.

[English text unavailable]

COL-802801

A red fruit is enjoying himself peacefully in the wine cellar.

Its rosy hue looks incredibly vibrant today, perhaps due to the wine.

APPLe: Good morning ... *burp* Or evening, my lady.

APPLe: Just as expected, the wine on this island is exquisite.

APPLe: I, this APPLe, pledges to personally take on the task of documenting these wines and preserving their names for posterity!

APPLe: They will be called "Cuvée Apeiron," in honor of this respectable school of thought.

Choices

1. But the School of Apeiron has been divided

2. Regulus might disagree
with the name

3. I should probably be off

Branch 1

APPLe: It pains this APPLe to the core that such a talented group of scholars parted ways over philosophical differences, Ms. Vertin.

APPLe: Disagreements are not always bad. Sometimes the spark of progress comes from the friction of ideas.

APPLe: The flaws in the foundation of calculus weren't discovered by a mathematician ...

APPLe: ... but by a theologian heavily involved in the study of religion.

APPLe: And for that, we should be grateful to him for bringing it to light.

APPLe: His insights revealed weaknesses in the concept of Infinitesimals, prompting a need for improvement.

APPLe: Thanks to his criticisms, mathematics was spared from becoming a palace of errors and lies.

APPLe: This APPLe believes that the current differences in the School of Apeiron will eventually lead to a greater unity.

APPLe: We should toast, *burp*, to differences.

Choices

1. I should probably be off

Branch 2

APPLe: That should not be a problem. She is still too young to drink.

APPLe: And this APPLe knows that deep down, she isn't as annoyed by the people and this island as she seems.

APPLe: In fact, she is a natural at adapting. After all, she settled into the Foundation with ease.

APPLe: The APPLe is immensely grateful that the Captain is always by your side and there is no need to worry.

APPLe: It should also be beneficial for her to see more of the timeline.

APPLe: But please watch over her, Ms. Vertin. Her rock star spirit may lead her to an early demise.

Vertin: What?

APPLe: Like other rock stars, the Captain's carefree and daring nature constantly puts her in danger, making every minute potentially her last.

APPLe: This is what this APPLe has observed in the rock community over the years.

Choices

1. I should probably be off

Branch 3

Shared continuation

APPLe: Bon Voyage, Ms. Vertin.

[English text unavailable]

COL-802802

APPLe: Would you like to learn more about this wine?

Choices

1. But the School of Apeiron has been divided

2. Regulus might disagree
with the name

3. I should probably be off

Branch 1

APPLe: It pains this APPLe to the core that such a talented group of scholars parted ways over philosophical differences, Ms. Vertin.

APPLe: Disagreements are not always bad. Sometimes the spark of progress comes from the friction of ideas.

APPLe: The flaws in the foundation of calculus weren't discovered by a mathematician ...

APPLe: ... but by a theologian heavily involved in the study of religion.

APPLe: And for that, we should be grateful to him for bringing it to light.

APPLe: His insights revealed weaknesses in the concept of Infinitesimals, prompting a need for improvement.

APPLe: Thanks to his criticisms, mathematics was spared from becoming a palace of errors and lies.

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APPLe: We should toast, *burp*, to differences.

Choices

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Branch 2

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APPLe: And this APPLe knows that deep down, she isn't as annoyed by the people and this island as she seems.

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APPLe: It should also be beneficial for her to see more of the timeline.

APPLe: But please watch over her, Ms. Vertin. Her rock star spirit may lead her to an early demise.

Vertin: What?

APPLe: Like other rock stars, the Captain's carefree and daring nature constantly puts her in danger, making every minute potentially her last.

APPLe: This is what this APPLe has observed in the rock community over the years.

Choices

1. I should probably be off

Branch 3

Shared continuation

APPLe: Bon Voyage, Ms. Vertin.

[English text unavailable]

COL-804101

Matilda: Vertin!

The voice's owner has found you before you could even look for her.

Like a trained athlete, the divination genius charges towards you, her orbuculum secured under her arm.

Matilda: Aha! Finally caught you!

Matilda: Think you can hide from me? Did you really think you could sneak off to the twist ball without the knowledge of the monitor assistant Matilda?

Vertin: Twist ball?

Matilda: You can't fool me. The lovely Sotheby has given away the details of your plan.

Matilda: You should feel lucky that I'm soft-hearted and generous with other people's mistakes. Now, if you invite me to this ball, I will forget about what happened.

Vertin: There is no twist ball, Matilda.

Matilda: Do you really expect me to believe that?! I ...

She sees the genuine look on your face, and her confidence starts to waver.

Matilda: Ah, do you mean that? Was Ms. Sotheby pulling a prank on me?

Vertin: Perhaps she forgot that she was supposed to hold the ball.

Matilda: So no one was left out, and she won't be doing some silly twist dance.

Matilda: Hmph! You'd better be telling the truth. I hope you will come up with a more tasteful event next time.

Matilda: And be sure to invite me! As the monitor assistant, I am obligated to be there and supervise.

Choices

1. You're welcome to join us

2. There could be a party if you'd like

3. Would you mind excusing me? I'll catch up with you soon

Branch 1

Matilda: Join, join you? You mean leaving here with you, also with, with, with her?

Matilda: *sneering* Hmph! You can't trick me into breaking the rules. I will become a Foundation investigator all on my own.

Matilda: And I will outdo you and Sonetto in this position!

Matilda: By then, you will be hoping to join me, not the reverse!

Choices

1. Would you mind excusing me? I'll catch up with you soon

Branch 2

Matilda: I, I never said I wanted a party!

Matilda: Unlike you, I've been keeping myself occupied as the monitor assistant.

Matilda: And I already have plans for my next holiday, and I will be visiting my mother in the one after that.

Matilda: If you want me at your party, make sure it is scheduled after my family time.

Choices

1. Would you mind excusing me? I'll catch up with you soon

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Matilda: Which is ...? Not another ball without me, I should hope.

Matilda: You're cleverer than this, Vertin! You know you can't fool me. I will be watching.

[English text unavailable]

COL-804102

Matilda: What is it? Something you want to tell me?

Choices

1. You're welcome to join us
2. There could be a party if you'd like
3. Would you mind excusing me? I'll catch up with you soon

Branch 1

Matilda: Join, join you? You mean leaving here with you, also with, with, with her?

Matilda: *sneering* Hmph! You can't trick me into breaking the rules. I will become a Foundation investigator all on my own.

Matilda: And I will outdo you and Sonetto in this position!

Matilda: By then, you will be hoping to join me, not the reverse!

Choices

1. Would you mind excusing me? I'll catch up with you soon

Branch 2

Matilda: I, I never said I wanted a party!

Matilda: Unlike you, I've been keeping myself occupied as the monitor assistant.

Matilda: And I already have plans for my next holiday, and I will be visiting my mother in the one after that.

Matilda: If you want me at your party, make sure it is scheduled after my family time.

Choices

1. Would you mind excusing me? I'll catch up with you soon

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Matilda: Which is ...? Not another ball without me, I should hope.

Matilda: You're cleverer than this, Vertin! You know you can't fool me. I will be watching.

[English text unavailable]

COL-805701

The dream-builder stands perfectly still by the sea, unaware of her surroundings.

A stack of gilded white umbrellas lies piled at her feet.

She keeps her weary eyes shut, her body swaying gently in the sea breeze.

Choices

1. Shake her awake
2. Put a jacket on her

Branch 1

Mesmer Jr.: Stop it! Bring me more straps, I need to hold him down ...

She gestures with her hands, still in her dreams as if she's stifling a scream.

Her actions throw off her balance and wake her up. She opens her eyes.

Mesmer Jr.: Vertin?

Mesmer Jr.: *sigh* ... Thought I would get some rest.

Branch 2

Mesmer Jr.: Urgh ... It's hot.

Mesmer Jr.: Please move these people out into the hallway, this room's turning into a sauna.

Shimmering sweat builds on her forehead until she slowly begins opening her eyes.

Mesmer Jr.: Vertin?

Mesmer Jr.: Thanks for the jacket. But I doubt anyone will catch a cold in this weather.

Shared continuation

Mesmer Jr.: It's been a while since we saw each other outside the Foundation, hasn't it?

Mesmer Jr.: I should probably thank you for the extra work you're causing me. Finally, I have a chance to escape the daily grind and enjoy some fresh air.

Mesmer Jr.: Even though some of the Foundation staff are starting to see me as your go-between ...

Mesmer Jr.: Whatever. It's nice to get away from the screaming patients once in a while. Here, the Equilibrium Umbrellas you requested.

Choices

1. Have you ever considered a different job?

2. How have the Laplace researchers been doing since the curse?

3. Thank you for bringing the umbrellas

Branch 1

Mesmer Jr.: To do what? Be your errand girl?

Mesmer Jr.: Sadly, the number of people losing their minds only increased over the years. I'll never be able to leave this job.

Mesmer Jr.: You should continue your efforts, Vertin. Find ways to minimize the impact of the "Storm" on people, as you did with the Equilibrium Umbrella.

Mesmer Jr.: That'll save me a lot of trouble.

Choices

1. Thank you for bringing the umbrellas

Branch 2

Mesmer Jr.: They are managing, but unfortunately, some were beyond saving when they recited the incantation.

Mesmer Jr.: The survivors were impacted in two different ways. Some looked fine on the outside, but their minds were definitely unstable.

Mesmer Jr.: Of those people, some were just tired and having a bad day. I put them to sleep. That was easy.

Mesmer Jr.: There were also people who were severely deformed by the curse. They had changed so much that they were unrecognizable.

Mesmer Jr.: These patients quickly adapted to their new appearance and began to enjoy scaring their colleagues.

Mesmer Jr.: Sometimes their pranks would go too far, and the traumatized victims would end up coming to me.

Mesmer Jr.: The sane arcanists are now more troublesome than the insane.

Mesmer Jr.: It just goes to show how unpredictable arcanists can be.

Choices

1. Thank you for bringing the umbrellas

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Mesmer Jr.: It's no big deal. Just part of the job.

Mesmer Jr.: Now, if you don't mind, please verify the delivery and confirm receipt of the items you requested.

Mesmer Jr.: The faster you count, the sooner ... I can ... take a break.

Her heavy eyelids slide closed again as she drifts into another dream.

[English text unavailable]

COL-805702

Mesmer Jr.: Done with the counting? There's no need to hurry. Get the numbers right, Vertin.

Choices

1. Have you ever considered a different job?

2. How have the Laplace researchers been doing since the curse?

3. Thank you for bringing the umbrellas

Branch 1

Mesmer Jr.: To do what? Be your errand girl?

Mesmer Jr.: Sadly, the number of people losing their minds only increased over the years. I'll never be able to leave this job.

Mesmer Jr.: You should continue your efforts, Vertin. Find ways to minimize the impact of the "Storm" on people, as you did with the Equilibrium Umbrella.

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Mesmer Jr.: It just goes to show how unpredictable arcanists can be.

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Mesmer Jr.: The faster you count, the sooner ... I can ... take a break.

Her heavy eyelids slide closed again as she drifts into another dream.

[English text unavailable]

COL-806601

A genius has decided to leave behind her orderly and familiar realm to dive into the chaotic currents of a new world.

She stands on the beach, lost in her thoughts, the waves gently lapping at her feet.

Choices

1. Tap on her shoulder

2. Stand beside her

Branch 1

Thirty-seven: Ah!

The sudden touch surprises her; she quickly turns around, her expression like a startled dolphin's.

Thirty-seven: What-what's wrong? I'm analyzing the ocean currents of the phenomenal world!

Branch 2

Thirty-seven: Vertin?

She notices your arrival, but her eyes are still fixed on the sea.

Thirty-seven: What's wrong? I'm calculating the perfect time to set sail.

Shared continuation

Choices

1. I know a person who only speaks in numbers

2. What do you plan to do once you leave the island?

3. I should get going

Branch 1

Thirty-seven: Really? I've had that idea before and brought it up with the Orator Congregation,

Thirty-seven: because the language of the phenomenal world was not precise enough, it often led to misunderstandings.

Thirty-seven: But when they tried it, most did not last a day.

Thirty-seven: I'm surprised there's another great mind like mine in the phenomenal world. They must have a special number!

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 2

Thirty-seven: This question is unresolved.

Thirty-seven: The outside world is too murky, too distant from the essence.

Thirty-seven: My mind becomes clouded and dull, limiting the power of my arcane skills.

Thirty-seven: But maybe I can take it on as a new project: make this murky world clean again!

Thirty-seven: I think it will be a lot of fun!

Thirty-seven: Sophia will love it too! ... If she comes back.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Thirty-seven: Mhm. I think we'll meet again soon.

[English text unavailable]

COL-806602

Thirty-seven: You're early for our reunion. Is your watch telling the wrong time again?

Choices

1. I know a person who only speaks in numbers
2. What do you plan to do once you leave the island?
3. I should get going

Branch 1

Thirty-seven: Really? I've had that idea before and brought it up with the Orator Congregation,

Thirty-seven: because the language of the phenomenal world was not precise enough, it often led to misunderstandings.

Thirty-seven: But when they tried it, most did not last a day.

Thirty-seven: I'm surprised there's another great mind like mine in the phenomenal world. They must have a special number!

Choices

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Branch 2

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Thirty-seven: The outside world is too murky, too distant from the essence.

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Thirty-seven: I think it will be a lot of fun!

Thirty-seven: Sophia will love it too! ... If she comes back.

Choices

1. I should get going

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Thirty-seven: Mhm. I think we'll meet again soon.

[English text unavailable]

COL-808501

The IDM has completed its mission, but its screen is still lit.

Someone is still on the line.

Enigma: It's a seven-letter word, the second letter is "A" and the third letter "I" ...

Enigma: Failing, failure, jailing, painful ...

Enigma: No, not these. Open your mind ...

Vertin: What about rainbow?

Enigma: Hm? Good one, then the sixth is "O," the start of "Opportunity" ...

Enigma: Wait, who's talking? There is no one around me.

Enigma: Is the IDM talking? Are you an Awakened one?

Vertin: This is Vertin speaking.

Enigma: The Timekeeper? I was so relaxed I forgot to check the microphone.

Enigma: Most of the staff is preparing funerals for the deceased.

Enigma: If you have anything to say, I'll pass it on.

Choices

1. That crossword puzzle was pretty pessimistic
2. How's Laplace been with Lucy gone?
3. I'll leave you to your puzzles then

Branch 1

Enigma: I was just going through words in alphabetical order.

Enigma: It had nothing to do with pessimism or my personal feelings.

Enigma: If you really want to call me that, then I'll say it takes one to know one.

Enigma: Pessimists have a knack for spotting their own kind.

Choices

1. I'll leave you to your puzzles then

Branch 2

Enigma: *sigh*

Enigma: She dumped a mess on Ulrich and I.

Enigma: The research team will become its own department and focus on studying the Equilibrium Umbrella.

Enigma: And Ulrich and I are going to head it. Once he's done with his "hunger strike," we'll have to decide who's going to be in charge of all the boring stuff Madam Lucy couldn't be bothered to deal with.

Enigma: ... stuff like politics, getting along with people, and working with other organizations.

Enigma: I must say that Laplace is being overly technocentric here.

Enigma: They couldn't find anyone else to head the department except for this unsociable researcher and this Awakened thing that can't even show emotions like a normal person.

Enigma: The social scene at Laplace is going to be a disaster.

Choices

1. I'll leave you to your puzzles then

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Enigma: So were you just here for small talk?

Enigma: I was told it would help with my resocialization. Thanks.

[English text unavailable]

COL-808502

Enigma: I am no arcanist. I can only draw conclusions from what I see.

Enigma: So if you have something to say, say it directly.

Choices

1. That crossword puzzle was pretty pessimistic
2. How's Laplace been with Lucy gone?
3. I'll leave you to your puzzles then

Branch 1

Enigma: I was just going through words in alphabetical order.

Enigma: It had nothing to do with pessimism or my personal feelings.

Enigma: If you really want to call me that, then I'll say it takes one to know one.

Enigma: Pessimists have a knack for spotting their own kind.

Choices

1. I'll leave you to your puzzles then

Branch 2

Enigma: *sigh*

Enigma: She dumped a mess on Ulrich and I.

Enigma: The research team will become its own department and focus on studying the Equilibrium Umbrella.

Enigma: And Ulrich and I are going to head it. Once he's done with his "hunger strike," we'll have to decide who's going to be in charge of all the boring stuff Madam Lucy couldn't be bothered to deal with.

Enigma: ... stuff like politics, getting along with people, and working with other organizations.

Enigma: I must say that Laplace is being overly technocentric here.

Enigma: They couldn't find anyone else to head the department except for this unsociable researcher and this Awakened thing that can't even show emotions like a normal person.

Enigma: The social scene at Laplace is going to be a disaster.

Choices

1. I'll leave you to your puzzles then

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Enigma: So were you just here for small talk?

Enigma: I was told it would help with my resocialization. Thanks.

[English text unavailable]

COL-808601

A lady sits in front of the IDM, her expression emotionless. She places a hand on her face, her fingers carefully running over her cheeks as if they were unfamiliar.

For a brief moment, you can't quite place who she is. You recognize the metal torso and limbs, but her face seems unfamiliar.

Lucy: Nice to meet you, Timekeeper.

Lucy: I have intended to visit you, but training interfered. Forgive me for meeting you like this instead.

Vertin: Training?

Lucy: Yes, training. I was instructed to leave Laplace and go on a vacation.

Lucy: Just as I was wondering where and how I was going to accomplish this task, Madam Z recommended your suitcase.

Lucy: So I prepared this spare body for easier communication with the members in your suitcase.

Lucy: Considering the presence of underage individuals, I opted for a softer material. Hopefully they will be comfortable with the temperature of my metal.

Lucy: As for my training, it is to master the art of resting.

Lucy: I would like to inquire, how does one define the concept of resting?

Choices

1. Resting is when you stop working for a while

2. Resting is when you focus on keeping yourself in good shape

3. I'll catch up with you later; we can discuss it then

Branch 1

Lucy: Apologies for the interruption, Timekeeper. This is a paradox.

Lucy: My work has ordered me to rest. If I were to stop working,

Lucy: then I would have to stop resting too. Please provide an alternative suggestion.

Choices

1. I'll catch up with you later; we can discuss it then

Branch 2

Lucy: I am glad that you and I have come to the same conclusion.

Lucy: Based on my observations, resting is what one does to recharge their physical and mental systems.

Lucy: Through the combination of a balanced diet, suitable exercise, and sufficient sleep.

Lucy: But these measures do not work for the Awakened.

Lucy: I require no sleep. My sustenance is electricity, and exercise quickens my deterioration.

Lucy: I suppose the closest definition of resting is the continuous charging of electricity.

Lucy: But from your perspective, can this not be categorized as the sin of gluttony?

Choices

1. I'll catch up with you later; we can discuss it then

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Lucy: See you soon, Timekeeper. Remember, we still need to complete the resting plan.

[English text unavailable]

COL-808602

Lucy: Any more advice on resting, Timekeeper?

Choices

1. Resting is when you stop working for a while
2. Resting is when you focus on keeping yourself in good shape
3. I'll catch up with you later; we can discuss it then

Branch 1

Lucy: Apologies for the interruption, Timekeeper. This is a paradox.

Lucy: My work has ordered me to rest. If I were to stop working,

Lucy: then I would have to stop resting too. Please provide an alternative suggestion.

Choices

1. I'll catch up with you later; we can discuss it then

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Lucy: But from your perspective, can this not be categorized as the sin of gluttony?

Choices

1. I'll catch up with you later; we can discuss it then

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Lucy: See you soon, Timekeeper. Remember, we still need to complete the resting plan.

[English text unavailable]

COL-851201

Your direct supervisor chooses the perfect place to meet. It's not too eye-catching, nor is it so quiet that you can't find her easily.

She's holding a medal in one hand and an award announcement speech in the other. Her thermos cup is left aside.

Z: Congratulations, Vertin. The Foundation is pleased with your recent performance.

Z: I am here to award you on behalf of the Foundation.

She puts the medal and speech in a folder and hands them to you.

Z: I know you are not a fan of these ceremonies. So here is your medal, and a brief statement on your achievements.

Choices

1. Are people still celebrating at the Foundation?

2. I can't express how much I appreciate your help, Madam Z

3. Is there a new mission?

Branch 1

Z: You could say that.

Z: But some wasted no time in securing their next step.

Z: They are already seeking partnership with Laplace on the development of the Equilibrium Umbrella.

Z: The umbrella will allow the Foundation to move freely during the "Storm." The committee should announce a new bill on field investigations soon.

Z: The balance within the Foundation will shift once more. The politicians will be busy.

Z: Speaking of balance, we should be equipping frontline investigators with Equilibrium Umbrellas as a top priority.

Choices

1. Is there a new mission?

Branch 2

Z: That was nothing compared to what you and your friends have done.

Z: Even though we now have the Equilibrium Umbrella to shield us from the "Storm,"

Z: we still have ways to go before we can truly understand it.

Z: We will get there, Vertin, slowly but surely.

Choices

1. Is there a new mission?

Branch 3

Shared continuation

Z: No need to rush, Vertin. Take your time and rest.

Z: Enjoy the company of your friends before you set out again.

Z: Don't worry about the reports, I'll handle them. You've been busy ever since becoming the Timekeeper, and you deserve a break.

[English text unavailable]

COL-851202

Z: Is there anything else, Vertin?

Choices

1. Are people still celebrating at the Foundation?

2. I can't express how much I appreciate your help, Madam Z

3. Is there a new mission?

Branch 1

Z: You could say that.

Z: But some wasted no time in securing their next step.

Z: They are already seeking partnership with Laplace on the development of the Equilibrium Umbrella.

Z: The umbrella will allow the Foundation to move freely during the "Storm." The committee should announce a new bill on field investigations soon.

Z: The balance within the Foundation will shift once more. The politicians will be busy.

Z: Speaking of balance, we should be equipping frontline investigators with Equilibrium Umbrellas as a top priority.

Choices

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